

POVERTY, HUNGER, FOOD AND NUTRITION SECURITY

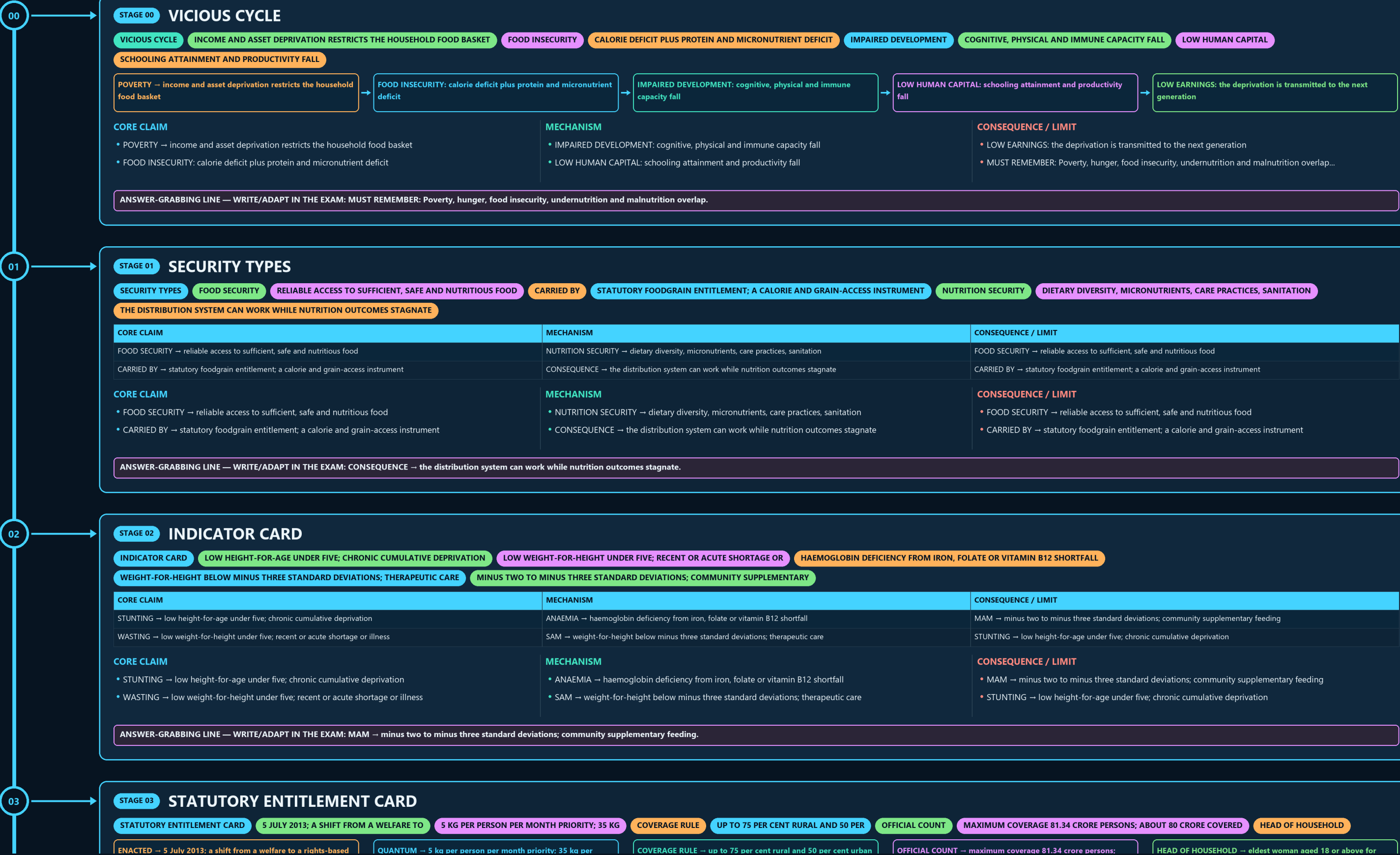
VICIOUS CYCLE → SECURITY TYPES → INDICATOR CARD → STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT CARD → PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD → LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

• STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation

• WASTING → low weight-for-height under five; recent or acute shortage or illness

• ANAEMIA → haemoglobin deficiency from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall

• SAM → weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations; therapeutic care

• MAM → minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding

• STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAM → minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding.

03

STAGE 03

STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT CARD

5 JULY 2013; A SHIFT FROM A WELFARE TO

5 KG PER PERSON PER MONTH PRIORITY; 35 KG

COVERAGE RULE

UP TO 75 PER CENT RURAL AND 50 PER

OFFICIAL COUNT

MAXIMUM COVERAGE 81.34 CRORE PERSONS; ABOUT 80 CRORE COVERED

HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD

ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach

QUANTUM → 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month

COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population

OFFICIAL COUNT → maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present

HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD → eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration

CORE CLAIM

ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach

QUANTUM → 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month Antyodaya

MECHANISM

COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population

OFFICIAL COUNT → maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD → eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration card

ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.

04

STAGE 04

PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD

PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD

STATUTORY CEILING

RICE 3 RUPEES, WHEAT 2 RUPEES, COARSE GRAINS 1

CURRENT POLICY

FREE OF COST TO ANTYODAYA AND PRIORITY HOUSEHOLDS SINCE

THE WELFARE GRAIN SCHEME WAS MERGED INTO THE ACT

THE UNION CABINET EXTENDED FREE DISTRIBUTION FOR FIVE YEARS

NEVER STATE THE CEILING AS THE PRICE A BENEFICIARY

CORE CLAIM

STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

CURRENT POLICY → free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023

MECHANISM

AUTHORITY → the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date

EXTENSION → the Union Cabinet extended free distribution for five years to December 2028

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays

STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

CORE CLAIM

STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

CURRENT POLICY → free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023

MECHANISM

AUTHORITY → the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date

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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays

STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays.

05

STAGE 05

LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS

LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN

NUTRITIOUS MEAL FREE OF COST; MATERNITY BENEFIT

MATERNITY BENEFIT

NOT LESS THAN 6000 RUPEES TO PARTLY COMPENSATE WAGE

CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS

MEAL THROUGH ANGANWADI CENTRES AND THROUGH SCHOOLS

MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit

MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS → meal through anganwadi centres and through schools

MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed

CORE CLAIM

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit

MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

MECHANISM

CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS → meal through anganwadi centres and through schools

MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit

MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed.

06

STAGE 06

REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY

REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY

THE ENTITLED PERSON MAY CLAIM A FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE

GOVERNED BY

THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE RULES, 2015

ALLOCATION, TRANSPORT TO DEPOTS AND ASSISTANCE TO THE FAIR-PRICE

IDENTIFICATION, RATION CARDS AND DISTRIBUTION OF THE ENTITLEMENT

ATTRIBUTE A DELIVERY FAILURE TO A NAMED TIER, NEVER

NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

GOVERNED BY → the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015

CENTRE → allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep

STATES → identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed.

06

STAGE 06 REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY

REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY

THE ENTITLED PERSON MAY CLAIM A FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE

GOVERNED BY

THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE RULES, 2015

ALLOCATION, TRANSPORT TO DEPOTS AND ASSISTANCE TO THE FAIR-PRICE

IDENTIFICATION, RATION CARDS AND DISTRIBUTION OF THE ENTITLEMENT

ATTRIBUTE A DELIVERY FAILURE TO A NAMED TIER, NEVER

NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

GOVERNED BY → the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015

CENTRE → allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep

STATES → identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

CORE CLAIM

- NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State
- GOVERNED BY → the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015

MECHANISM

- CENTRE → allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep
- STATES → identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- USE → attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general
- NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: USE → attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general.

07

STAGE 07 SERVICE LAYERS BY AGE

SERVICE LAYERS BY AGE

POSHAN 2.0

MINISTRY OF WOMEN AND CHILD DEVELOPMENT; ANGANWADI CENTRES

ITS SERVICES

SUPPLEMENTARY NUTRITION, GROWTH MONITORING, PRE-SCHOOL, REFERRAL

PM POSHAN

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION; COOKED MEAL IN CLASSES I TO

ITS OBJECTIVES

CORE CLAIM

POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres
ITS SERVICES → supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral

MECHANISM

PM POSHAN → Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII
ITS OBJECTIVES → attendance, retention and improved nutritional status

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions
POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres

CORE CLAIM

- POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres
- ITS SERVICES → supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral

MECHANISM

- PM POSHAN → Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII
- ITS OBJECTIVES → attendance, retention and improved nutritional status

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions
- POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions.

08

STAGE 08 RATION FORMAT TRADE-OFF

RATION FORMAT TRADE-OFF

TAKE-HOME RATION

DRY RATION COOKED AT HOME; PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN

ALSO FOR

CHILDREN BETWEEN SIX MONTHS AND THREE YEARS

HOT COOKED MEAL

SERVED AT THE ANGANWADI CENTRE OR THE SCHOOL

THE HOT MEAL GUARANTEES CONSUMPTION AT THE POINT OF

CORE CLAIM

TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women
ALSO FOR → children between six months and three years

MECHANISM

HOT COOKED MEAL → served at the anganwadi centre or the school
GAIN → the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed
TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women

CORE CLAIM

- TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women
- ALSO FOR → children between six months and three years

MECHANISM

- HOT COOKED MEAL → served at the anganwadi centre or the school
- GAIN → the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed
- TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed.

09

STAGE 09 PORTABILITY MECHANISM

PORTABILITY MECHANISM

A MIGRANT IS LISTED ON A STATE-SPECIFIC ROLL AND

AADHAAR-SEEDED RATION CARD READ AT AN ELECTRONIC POINT-OF-SALE MACHINE

THE EXISTING ENTITLEMENT IS DRAWN AT ANY ENABLED FAIR-PRICE

IT IS NOT A SEPARATE CARD AND NOT A

CLAIM LIMIT

THE CUMULATIVE TRANSACTION COUNT RISES CONTINUOUSLY AND IS NOT

CLOSE DISTINCTION

PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving

MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine

EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop

LIMIT → it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement

CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here

CORE CLAIM

- PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving
- MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine

MECHANISM

- EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop
- LIMIT → it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Poverty incidence is not death, food availability is not household

09

STAGE 09 PORTABILITY MECHANISM

PORTABILITY MECHANISM A MIGRANT IS LISTED ON A STATE-SPECIFIC ROLL AND MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop LIMIT — it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement CLAIM LIMIT — the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here

THE CUMULATIVE TRANSACTION COUNT RISES CONTINUOUSLY AND IS NOT CLOSE DISTINCTION

PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving

MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine

EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop

LIMIT — it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement

CLAIM LIMIT — the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here

CORE CLAIM

- PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving
- MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine

MECHANISM

- EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop
- LIMIT → it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Poverty incidence is not depth, food availability is not household...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Poverty incidence is not depth, food availability is not household.

10

STAGE 10 CONVERGENCE BANK

CONVERGENCE BANK FEEDING, MICRONUTRIENTS, GROWTH MONITORING, BREASTFEEDING SUPPORT WATER AND SANITATION, AGRICULTURE, SOCIAL PROTECTION, GIRLS SCHOOLING THE NATIONAL ANAEMIA STRATEGY USES A SIX-BY-SIX-BY-SIX INTERVENTION DESIGN

REACHES SELECTED MICRONUTRIENT GAPS AT SCALE IT CANNOT REPLACE DIETARY DIVERSITY, INFECTION CONTROL, SAFE WATER EVIDENCE LIMIT USE NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/SAKSHAM ANGANWADI

NUTRITION-SPECIFIC → feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support

NUTRITION-SENSITIVE → water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling

ANAEMIA → the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design

FORTIFICATION → reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale

LIMIT → it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment

CORE CLAIM

- NUTRITION-SPECIFIC → feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support
- NUTRITION-SENSITIVE → water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling

MECHANISM

- ANAEMIA → the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design
- FORTIFICATION → reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LIMIT → it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi,.

11

STAGE 11 DATED OUTCOME AND ANSWER SPINE

DATED OUTCOME AND ANSWER SPINE ROUND FIVE 2019-21 STUNTING 35.5, WASTING 19.3, CHILD ANAEMIA 67.1 PER CENT ROUND SIX 2023-24 UNDER-FIVE STUNTING 29.3 PER CENT; RELEASED 29 MAY 2026 ROUND SIX COVERED 715 DISTRICTS AND ABOUT 6.79 LAKH

NAME THE ROUND BESIDE EVERY VALUE AND NEVER MERGE AVAILABILITY, ACCESS, ABSORPTION AND UTILISATION, THEN A GRADED VERDICT

ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent

ROUND SIX 2023-24 → under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026

SCOPE → round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households

RULE → name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds

CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict

CORE CLAIM

- ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent
- ROUND SIX 2023-24 → under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026

MECHANISM

- SCOPE → round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households
- RULE → name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict
- ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT HIGHEST RETURN ON INTERVENTION POSHAN 2.0 (FIRST-1000-DAYS FOCUS), PM POSHAN (SCHOOL) WASH CONVERGENCE (SBM, JJM), INCOME SUPPORT (DBT) ONORC FOR MIGRANT-WORKER INCLUSION. NFSA, 2013

STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT; STATE-WISE IDENTIFICATION OF PRIORITY POSHAN 2.0

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- highest return on intervention
- Nutrition-specific: Poshan 2.0 (first-1000-days focus), PM POSHAN (school)
- Nutrition-sensitive: WASH convergence (SBM, JJM), income support (DBT,
- Portability: ONORC for migrant-worker inclusion.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- NFSA, 2013: Statutory entitlement; state-wise identification of priority
- Poshan 2.0 / Saksham Anganwadi (MWCD): Consolidates ICDS, Poshan Abhiyaan
- PM POSHAN (MoE): Centrally-sponsored scheme with cost-sharing between
- ONORC: Requires Aadhaar seeding of ration cards, ePoS deployment at

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: Poshan Tracker (app): Real-time data entry by anganwadi workers for
- 2024 GS-II PYQ Q7: The question directly tests the vicious-cycle concept
- CAUTION: ONORC during COVID-19 lockdowns: Enabled migrant workers stranded outside
- CAUTION: NFHS-5 inter-state variation: States like Kerala and Tamil Nadu have low

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.